A SHIPPER'S RESOURCE

Export and Industrial Packaging Readiness Checklist

12 things to confirm before you book your next shipment, so nothing slips at the border.

Why Poor Packing Costs You

Damage, rejected shipments and failed inspections often start with packaging that was not designed for the cargo or the route. Mills Packaging works with Mills Dangerous Goods and Mills Projects to protect cargo through every handoff.

Work through each point before you book. If you cannot tick a box, that is the item to resolve first.

The Readiness Checklist

- [ ] **1. The cargo profile is written down**
  Record dimensions, weight, center of gravity and fragility, so packaging is designed around the actual cargo.

- [ ] **2. Route and handling risks are mapped**
  List the transport modes, transfers and storage the cargo will face, and where it is most likely to be stressed.

- [ ] **3. The packaging type is chosen**
  Select crates, pallets, cases or wraps that suit the cargo and its route, rather than a standard option.

- [ ] **4. Wood packaging meets treatment rules**
  Confirm that wooden crates and pallets meet the ISPM 15 treatment standard and are marked accordingly.

- [ ] **5. Moisture and corrosion protection is planned**
  Plan barriers, desiccants or coatings for cargo that will face humidity, sea air or long storage.

- [ ] **6. Vacuum and protective wrapping is considered**
  For sensitive equipment, decide whether vacuum or barrier packaging is needed, and how it will be checked.

- [ ] **7. Dangerous goods packaging is coordinated**
  If any item is a dangerous good, confirm that its packaging meets the rules for its class and transport mode.

- [ ] **8. Palletization and unitization are set**
  Decide how items are grouped and secured on pallets or skids so they can be lifted and moved safely.

- [ ] **9. The container stuffing plan is ready**
  Plan how cargo will be loaded, including weight distribution and use of space, before the container arrives.

The Readiness Checklist (continued)

- [ ] **10. Lashing and securing are specified**
  Confirm the materials and method used to hold cargo in place, matched to the weight and the route.

- [ ] **11. Marking and labeling are complete**
  Check that handling marks, shipping marks and labels are applied and readable on every package.

- [ ] **12. Packing documentation matches the cargo**
  Make sure the packing list, weights and photos agree with what is actually in each package.

Not sure every box is ticked? Let Mills Packaging review it with you.

Book a short call and we will walk through your next shipment and flag anything to resolve before it moves.

BOOK A CALL

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General guidance only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by product and shipment; confirm with The Mills before booking.